

Ilya - Director of Software Engineering

SUMMARY

- Engineering leader with 20+ years of experience across software development, platform-level system design, and organisational leadership in high-growth and mission-driven environments.
 - Experienced at operating at senior leadership and board level, improving delivery predictability, and driving alignment across Engineering, Product, Operations, and Customer Success.
 - Focused on designing effective operating rhythms and models, reducing ambiguity, and enabling multi-team organisations to deliver consistently under pressure - combining deep technical expertise with pragmatic leadership to balance short-term delivery with long-term scalability and resilience.
 - Proven track record of building high-performing engineering teams, establishing scalable delivery systems, and aligning technology execution with business strategy.
 - Championed engineering excellence through CI/CD, DevOps, cloud-native architectures, infrastructure as code, and AI-assisted practices - embedding quality, reliability, and sustainable delivery across the engineering organisation.
 - Established and maintained trusted relationships with executive teams, boards, business stakeholders, and customers.
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WORK EXPERIENCE

Mindhive - Head of Engineering

Feb 2025 - present · full-time · AI/ML, industrial computer vision

AI/ML company delivering industrial computer vision solutions for automated grading, defect detection, and operational workflows.

Highlights

- Established engineering leadership structure, improving alignment, accountability, and team effectiveness.
- Designed and implemented a new delivery operating rhythm to drive delivery predictability and reduce disruption from reactive demand.
- Introduced structured intake, triage, and prioritisation across Engineering, Product, and Customer Success.
- Implemented engineering flow metrics, improving visibility of demand, delivery performance, and system constraints.
- Supported shift toward a more productised and scalable operating model.
- Strengthened platform operations and follow-the-sun sustainment capability, improving production resilience.
- Accelerated adoption of AI-assisted engineering practices to improve delivery effectiveness.
- Lead engineering across software, platform, and ML delivery in a globally distributed startup (NZ, Brazil, Europe).

- Contributed to SLT and board discussions on capacity, prioritisation, security posture, and organisational design.

Tech: AWS, Python, React.js, Angular.js, DataDog, JIRA, Confluence

Tradify - Senior Software Engineering Manager

Dec 2023 - Feb 2025 · full-time · SaaS, field service management

High-growth SaaS platform for trades businesses, scaling rapidly across international markets.

Highlights

- Initiated and delivered frontend modernisation (AngularJS → React) with a zero-downtime migration approach.
- Introduced flow metrics across engineering and product, enabling data-driven delivery decisions.
- Identified and resolved systemic platform misuse, reducing spamming incidents by ~75%.
- Established structured initiatives to reduce technical debt and improve system health.
- Transitioned performance management to continuous feedback, improving engagement and development.
- Strengthened engineering culture, increasing psychological safety and team effectiveness.
- Led multiple engineering teams, aligning delivery with product strategy and scaling objectives.
- Acted as a key interface between engineering and senior leadership.

Tech: React, AngularJS

Te Kete Hono - Head of Technology

May 2020 - Oct 2024 · contract · EdTech, SaaS

Social impact enterprise backed by Hugh Green Foundation, delivering 3 SaaS products to 20,000+ users across the education sector. Mission-driven to accelerate learning in schools through cutting-edge technology and pedagogy.

Highlights

- Established and maintained a technology governance framework to drive development excellence across 3 SaaS platforms.
- Built a self-organising, high-performing team of 6 engineers to deliver across three concurrent SaaS platforms.
- Prepared data privacy and security policies, terms of use and code of conduct protecting the data of 20,000+ users.
- Improved customer satisfaction by transitioning to microservice architecture, improving average response times by 30% and by 75% during peak hours.
- Planned and executed infrastructure modernisation and cloud provider migration, reducing operational costs by 50%.
- Implemented Secure Development Life Cycle practices and passed an external security audit with zero risks reported and 100% compliance rating achieved.
- Orchestrated the on-time and under-budget launch of an ed-tech product, utilising agile methodologies to reduce time-to-market by 25%.

- Developed strategic technology vision and 3-year rolling development roadmap aligned with business objectives; directed operational management across all 3 SaaS products.
- Managed stakeholder and board relationships, including supporting the business sale and presenting product, architecture, and team capability to due diligence participants.
- Drove change in engineering culture, guided team maturity, and advised members on career development.

Tech: CI/CD pipelines, Azure DevOps, C# .NET, Azure Functions, React, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, Azure Blob Storage, JavaScript ES6, Entity Framework, Jest, React Testing Library, Material UI, Git, YAML, SonarCloud, Webpack Module Federation, Azure Queues, Azure Tables

Serko - Software Engineering Manager

Aug 2019 - Apr 2020 · contract · Corporate travel and expense management, SaaS

Technology company offering intelligent corporate travel and expense solutions, controlling more than 70% of the corporate travel market in New Zealand and Australia.

Highlights

- Built a tightly knit team of 6 developers.
- Created a safe, open culture to stimulate collaboration across 5 teams.
- Coached developers, promoted knowledge sharing, increased team performance by 50% through pair programming and mobbing.
- Reduced error rates on critical pathways by 90%.
- Promoted a 'build it and own it' mindset where developers own 100% of the software development life cycle of the code they have developed.
- Guided teams to stabilise the platform: created visibility of production issues, removed the fear of deployment, raised the maturity of development practices, and improved code quality.
- Facilitated the shift from 'startup' to 'scale-up' operating model, realigning team structure to product and business objectives and modernising product architecture.

Tech: React, Redux, TypeScript, Node.js, C# .NET, Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, App Insights, SQL Server, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, LUIS, Uneeq

Propellerhead - Product Owner / Development Manager

Oct 2017 - Nov 2019 · contract · Digital consultancy

Digital consultancy helping businesses make pragmatic and cost-efficient technology decisions, managing clients across government, commercial, and startup sectors.

Highlights

- Identity migration across 10 corporate websites.
- MVP delivery for NZ-based AML startup on time and budget.
- Design and development of professional learning and development system.
- Video streaming platform prototype for a NZ leading rugby team.
- Implementation of Silverstripe content management system for a NZ leading rugby team.
- Liaised with client stakeholders to define product vision and product roadmap; managed expectations and coordinated deliverables with 10 vendors.

Tech: Azure, AWS, React, Redux, TypeScript, Node.js, C# .NET, MySQL, MongoDB, Cosmos DB, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, Auth0, Silverstripe

Schooltalk - Co-founder / Software Engineering Manager

Jan 2015 - Sep 2017 · co-founder · EdTech, SaaS

Social impact startup that developed a software platform to help teachers track student progress, monitor engagement, and assess achievement based on evidence, including student self-assessment.

Fraedom.com - Senior Full-Stack Software Developer

Apr 2013 - Jan 2015 · full-time · FinTech, expense management

Technology partner of VISA providing Total Transaction Management solutions.

Freightways - Senior Analyst-Programmer

Nov 2007 - Mar 2013 · full-time · Logistics and courier services

New Zealand courier and logistics company operating NZ Couriers, DX Mail, Post Haste, Pass the Parcel, and Castle Parcels.

Thor United - Senior Analyst-Programmer

Feb 2006 - Nov 2007 · full-time · Investment and financial services

Investment company based in Russia/USA.

Nicotech International - Analyst-Programmer

Apr 2005 - Oct 2005 · full-time · Software development

Software house.

Sportmaster - Analyst-Programmer

Sep 2001 - Apr 2005 · full-time · Retail, sportswear

Leading sportswear retailer in Russia.

EDUCATION

- **Postgraduate Diploma in Information Technology and Computer Science** - Auckland University of Technology
 - **Postgraduate Diploma in Business Analysis** - Russian Academy of National Economy
 - **Master of Applied Physics and Mathematics** - Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology
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PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & COMMUNITY

- **Executive Coaching with Noah Cantor** (2024-present)
- **Executive Coaching with Paul Birch** (2025-present)
- **Founded and facilitate a peer forum of engineering leaders** focused on scaling teams, delivery systems, and leadership effectiveness
- **Mentor at University of Auckland Chiasma programme**
- **Chair, local VEX V5 robotics club** supporting homeschooled students in competitive robotics (2026)